PP-C-002199(Army-GL)
December 17, 1984

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN CACCIATORE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers chicken cacciatore thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, For Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20250.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Forth Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

FSC 8940

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification For

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900	-	Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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Regulations Governing the Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards and Grades

(Application for copies should be addressed to Director, Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms
U.S. Standards for Grades of Tomato Paste

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearney Street, No. 410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

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American Public Health Association

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, 1015 18th Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

National Academy of Sciences

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall be prepared from fresh chilled or frozen (ready-to-cook) fowl (mature female chicken). The chickens shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate and chilling and freezing procedures shall comply with USDA Poultry Products Inspection Regulations.

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3.2.1.1 Chilled chicken. Chicken received in the chilled state shall not be previously frozen and shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 4 days following initial chilling to further processing (see 3.3). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate, certifying initial chilling date. Chicken shall not show any evidence of freezing or thawing.

3.2.1.2 Frozen chicken. Raw (uncooked) chickens received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature not to exceed 0°F for a period of time not to exceed 75 days following initial freezing to processing (see 3.3). The chicken shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Grading Branch Certificate certifying the initial freezing (in-storage) date.

3.2.1.3 Chicken, diced, frozen, precooked. Precooked, frozen chicken shall be mechanically diced with dice setting to approximately 1/2 by 1/2 by 1/2 inch. In this case, conditions in 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.1.2 shall apply prior to cooking. Not less than 95 percent of the dice shall be of the specified size after dicing and prior to packaging. The cooked dice shall be frozen to 0°F within 72 hours after cooking, packaged and sealed in water impermeable material having an oxygen permeability of not more than 10 cc of oxygen per square meter per 24 hours per mil thickness at 73°F and 0 percent relative humidity. The packaged frozen chicken dices shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 30 days prior to tray pack filling (see 3.4).

3.2.2 Broth, chicken. Chicken broth may be purchased frozen or canned (thermostabilized). The broth shall be clear, essentially fat free with percent solids sufficient to comply with the solids requirement in the sauce formulation. The broth shall have a characteristic mild chicken broth odor and flavor and may contain flavor enhancers approved by Food and Drug Administration. The chicken broth shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and when frozen shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to formulation.

3.2.3 Chicken fat. Frozen chicken fat shall be purchased. The chicken fat shall have a characteristic clear yellow color, chicken-fat odor and flavor. The chicken fat may contain antioxidants approved by the Food Safety Inspection Service (FSIS) of USDA. The chicken fat shall have a peroxide value not to exceed 6 meq./kg., a free fatty acid value not to exceed 0.50 percent as oleic acid, and a moisture content not to exceed 0.25 percent. The chicken fat shall be produced in a USDA inspected plant in accordance with USDA regulations and shall have been held at 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 75 days prior to sauce formulation.

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3.2.4 Celery seed, ground. Ground celery seed shall be prepared from the seed of Apium graveolens L. The ground celery seed shall be light to rich brown in color and possess a characteristic celery odor and flavor with a warm slightly bitter aftertaste. The celery seed shall contain not less than 2 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 55 sieve.

3.2.5 Cheese, parmesan, grated. The grated parmesan cheese shall possess a characteristic, full-bodied, mild, slightly piquant, nutty Parmesan cheese taste and aroma, and shall be free from musty, oxidized (cardboard), tallowy, soapy or unclean flavors. The product shall have a uniform light cream to light natural-straw color. The particles shall be free flowing and free from lumps except those that break up readily with a slight finger pressure.

3.2.6 Bay leaves, ground. Ground bay leaves shall be derived from the dried leaves of Laurus nobilis L. and shall have a delicate aromatic odor and bitter flavor. There shall be no more than 0.3 percent stems by weight. Bay leaves shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams and shall be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 30 sieve.

3.2.7 Starch, waxy maize, modified. The starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified waxy maize starch for use in canned foods. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. It shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress and conditions of cold storage. The starch shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.8 Fennel seed, ground. The ground fennel seed shall be derived from the clean, dried, ripe fruit of Folniculum vulgare M. The seeds shall be finely ground, green or yellow-tan in color and have a pleasant, aromatic odor and possess a sweet, anise-like taste. The ground fennel shall have a volatile oil content of not less than 1 mL/100 g and a minimum of 95 percent shall pass through a No. 25 sieve.

3.2.9 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.10 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

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3.2.11 Mushrooms, canned, stems and pieces. The canned mushrooms shall be U.S. Grade B or better, Stems and Pieces of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Mushrooms. The mushrooms shall be drained prior to use in the sauce formulation.

3.2.12 Onions, chopped, dehydrated. The dehydrated chopped onion shall be fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.13 Oregano, ground. Ground oregano shall be derived from the dried leaves of Origanum vulgare L and shall have a strong camphoraceous aroma and a pungent slightly bitter flavor. The ground oregano shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams and shall be of such size than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.14 Green pepper, diced, dehydrated. Green pepper shal be dehydrated green pepper dices (1/4 inch by 1/4 inch) made from matured green, sweet, or sweet-bell peppers. The peppers shall possess a uniform bright green color and shall be free from damage caused by hail, sunburn diseases, insects, or mechanical damage.

3.2.15 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The ground white pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor and a light color. The white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.16 Salt. Salt shall be non-iodized, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.2.17 Sugar. The sugar shall be clean, white, refined, sucrose, granulated, cane or beet sugar or both. The sugar shall comply with the requirements of MIL-STD-900.

3.2.18 Tomato paste. The tomato paste shall be U.S. Grade A of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Tomato Paste. See formulation (see 3.3.2) for required soluble solids content.

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3.2.19 Tomatoes, crushed, canned. Canned crushed tomatoes shall be high quality, peeled, crushed tomatoes packed in puree with a solids content not less than 80 percent.

3.2.20 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.21 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and further processing.

3.3.1 Chicken preparation. The chicken shall be prepared as follows:

a. The chicken shall be made boneless and skinless and trimmed of all tendons, cartilage, large blood vessels, blood clots, discolorations, bruises, blemishes, feathers and hair. The chicken shall be cooked by water cooking, roasting or steaming. The broth from cooking the chicken may be used in the sauce preparation in the amount and in compliance with the solids content as required. The deboned chicken shall consist by weight of not less than 50 percent but not more than 60 percent white meat and not less than 40 percent but not more than 50 percent dark meat.

b. The cooked chicken shall be cooled to 40°F or below immediately following the cooking process and held at that temperature or lower for not longer than 48 hours prior to filling.

c. The cooked chicken meat shall be mechanically diced with dice settings at approximately 1/2 by 1/2 by 1/2 inch.

d. The cooked dice shall be screened after dicing. Not less than 95 percent of the dice shall be of the specified size after dicing and prior to filling.

e. Precooked, frozen chicken dices of the same dimensions may be purchased from a commercial deboning operation and shall comply with the requirements of 3.2.1 and 3.3.1, items a, b, c, and d. If frozen, precooked chicken is used, chicken broth will have to be purchased.

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3.3.3 Preparation of the sauce. The sauce shall be formulated as follows:

Ingredients	Percent by weight
Chicken broth (3.0 to 3.5% solids)	56.61
Tomato, crushed	16.00
Mushrooms, stems, and pieces, canned, drained	8.46
Tomato paste (24 to 28 percent soluble solids) 1/	5.00
Chicken fat	4.00
Starch, waxy maize, modified	3.50
Onions, chopped, dehyrated	3.45
Salt	1.25
Cheese parmesan, grated	0.50
Sugar, granulated	0.50
Green pepper, diced, dehydrated	0.30
Lecithin	0.20
Pepper, white, ground	0.09
Garlic powder	0.06
Oregano, ground	0.03
Bay leaf, ground	0.02
Celery seed, ground	0.02
Fennel seed, ground	0.01

1/ Tomato products with different soluble solids content shall be adjusted to the required solids content.

a. A slurry shall be made with the starch and part of the chicken broth. Add the remaining chicken broth to a steam-jacketed kettle and add the remaining ingredients, except the spices. Heat the mixture to 140° - 150°F and add the spices.

b. The slurry shall be added and the final mixture heated to 180° to 190°F and held in this temperature range for 5 minutes.

c. The volume of the final mixture shall be adjusted to compensate for evaporation loss during heating and holding.

d. The sauce shall be filled into the tray pack cans within 4 hours after cooking. The temperature of the prepared sauce shall be held at 150° - 180°F until filling into the tray cans.

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3.3.3 Product preparation. The chicken cacciatore shall be prepared as follows:

a. The chicken dices and sauce shall be combined and blended in the following proportions prior to filling in the tray cans:

Ingredient	Percent
Chicken, diced	49.00
Sauce	51.00

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. The temperature of the chicken at time of filling shall be between 28° to 40°F.

b. The temperature of the sauce shall be 150°F or higher at the time of filling.

c. Each can shall be hermetically sealed (under a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury) immediately after filling.

d. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 1 hour after being filled.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6.0 has been achieved.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as but not limited to glass, paint, metal, dirt, insect, insect parts, hair, wood, or paper.

b. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors, such as but not limited to rancid, scorched, burnt, stale, sour or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

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d. The average net weight shall be not less than 106 ounces.

e. No individual can shall have a net weight of less than 104 ounces.

f. There shall be no bone pieces measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

g. There shall be no cartilage or section of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

h. There shall be no pieces of skin, blood clot, bruises, or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 40 ounces of drained, discernible chicken dices.

j. Texture of chicken dices shall not be dry, rubbery or mushy.

k. Texture of mushrooms shall not be mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough.

l. Sauce consistency shall be smooth, without lumps, and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

m. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 7.0 percent.

n. The fat content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 9.0 percent.

o. The salt content of an individual tray pack shall be not greater than 1.0 percent.

p. No individual can shall contain less than 3.5 ounes of mushrooms.

3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Poultry Products Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

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3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

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4.5 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, can interior coating, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.6 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.6.1 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.6.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table I. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated for at least 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened, and inspected for the defects listed in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection. 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0-3200	8		0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201-35000	13		0	3
	13	26	3	4

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1/ a. If no defects are found, the lot shall be acceptable.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product inspection 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
151	Presence of bone measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
152	Presence of cartilage or sections of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
153	Presence of skin, blood clots, bruise or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
154	Drained weight of discernible chicken dices in a can is less than 40 ounces. 3/
155	Drained weight of mushrooms dices in a can is less than 3.5 ounces. 3/
156	Texture of chicken dices dry, rubbery or mushy. 3/
157	Sauce consistency lumpy or is excessively thick or thin.
158	Texture of mushrooms mushy, hard, fibrous, or tough. 4/

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1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insert parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee or a Poultry Grading Branch representative.)

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the entire contents of each can shall be poured into a suitable container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The product shall be stirred gently to assure the sauce is fully diluted without breaking the chicken or mushrooms. The diluted sauce shall be decanted through a U.S. Standard 1/4-inch sieve. Any mushrooms or chicken on the sieve shall be returned to the mixing container. A volume of tap water equal to the volume of two tray pack cans shall be added to the product. The product shall be stirred gently for approximately 5 seconds. The total contents shall be poured onto a U.S. Standard 1/4-inch sieve and allowed to drain for 2 minutes. The sieve shall be tilted at an approximate 45° angle to facilitate draining. Only discernible chicken dices and the mushrooms shall be manually removed and weighed separately. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ Examination for chicken dice and mushroom texture conformance shall be made of representative chicken dices and mushroom pieces immediately following the determination of drained weight (see footnote 3/).

4.6.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray packs shall be selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

-Three for laboratory analysis.
-Three for submission to the contractor.
-Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analysis shall be individually tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat, except that preparation of the samples shall be as

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follows. The three unopened tray packs shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs is greater than 7.0 percent.
b. The fat content in any individual tray pack is greater than 9.0 percent.
c. The salt content in any individual tray pack is greater than 1.0 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve sample is analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) Reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used; (4) Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box; (5) Length or width of pads less than box dimensions by more than 1/8 inch; (6) Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of the food product, sealed and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated with material suitable for the product. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard. Each fiberboard box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to non-metallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

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5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimension of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.7 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. Cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge unopened can in boiling water. Simmer gently 35 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving. Caution: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

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WARNING: Do not place closed cans in oven, as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Sixteen (16) 3/4 cup servings.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/ DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

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Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-A440

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
PP-C-002199(Army-GL)	Chicken Cacciatore, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 20 Nov 84

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